

for the new generation GSM networks and the first phone to take the shape that we now know as the candy-bar. Of course, there was the little antenna that needed getting rid of.

1996 was a momentous year for both Nokia and Motorola. Nokia showcased its all-in-one mobile communication device (phone was too lowly a term)—the Nokia 9000 communicator at the CeBIT exhibition that year. This big block could access the Internet using WAP (Wireless Access Patrol), store your personal data and appointments, had a huge 640 x 200 display, and came with a QWERTY keyboard.

Motorola, meanwhile, released the phone which would create a whole new genre of mobile phone design—the first ‘Clamshell’, the Motorola StarTAC.



The Motorola StarTAC—the first clamshell

Time moved on and mobile phone designers stuck to either the candy-bar with antenna or the clamshell style phones. But while the outside remained relatively the same, the insides were undergoing a major overhaul.



The Ericsson T68

With the introduction of the WAP, users could browse the internet from their WAP-enabled mobile phones—keep up with the latest news, send and receive e-mail and so on. The Ericsson R 320 was the first WAP phone to get a nod of approval from the WAP Forum, the developers of the WAP standard.

The Ericsson T68 heralded a new era in mobile entertainment with its new 256-colour screen. Everything was suddenly so *pretty*.